

**AN ANALYTICAL STUDY OF CUSTOMER PERCEPTION
TOWARDS RETAIL AND INSTITUTIONAL LOANS AT
SHRIRAM FINANCE**

A Project Report Submitted to
Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad
In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of
MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

Submitted by:

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that DUDEKULA SANA SULTHANA , H.T NO: **24WJ1E0042** has completed the project entitled An Analytical study of customer perception towards retail and institutional loan at Shriram finance **Company Name: Shriram finance**, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of degree of Master of Business Administration prescribed by **Guru Nanak Institutions Technical Campus (Autonomous)** Affiliated to **Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University Hyderabad** for the Academic year **2025-2026**

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STUDENT DECLARATION

I hereby, declare that the work presented in this project titled **An Analytical study of customer perception towards retail and institutional loan at Shriram finance.** is carried out by me under the Project Supervisor of **Mr. Kamalakar Rao**, Assistant Professor, of the Department of School of Management Studies. I have acknowledged references from all sources including the internet sources wherever applicable.

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1. INTRODUCTION

The financial services sector plays a pivotal role in shaping economic growth, fostering entrepreneurship, and improving the standard of living by enabling access to credit. Within this broad ecosystem, lending institutions—particularly Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)—have emerged as critical enablers of financial inclusion, especially in emerging economies like India. Among such institutions, Shriram Finance Limited has established itself as a prominent player, particularly in catering to underserved and semi-urban segments through a diversified portfolio of retail and institutional lending products.

This study, titled “*An Analytical Study of Customer Perception Towards Retail and Institutional Loans at Shriram Finance*”, focuses on understanding how customers perceive the loan products and services offered by the company. Customer perception, in the context of financial services, refers to the attitudes, beliefs, expectations, and satisfaction levels that customers develop based on their interactions with the institution, its products, and service delivery mechanisms. In a highly competitive financial landscape, customer perception is not only a determinant of customer retention but also a key driver of brand reputation and longterm sustainability.

Retail and institutional loans represent two fundamentally distinct segments within the lending portfolio. Retail loans typically include personal loans, vehicle loans, gold loans, and small business financing extended to individuals and small enterprises. These loans are characterized by smaller ticket sizes, higher volume, and a greater reliance on customer relationships and service quality. On the other hand, institutional loans are extended to corporate entities, financial institutions, and large organizations. These loans involve larger amounts, more complex risk assessments, and often depend on formal financial metrics and creditworthiness evaluations.

Understanding customer perception in both these segments is essential because the expectations, evaluation criteria, and satisfaction determinants vary significantly between retail and institutional customers. Retail customers often prioritize accessibility, speed of service, interest rates, transparency, and customer support. Institutional customers, in contrast, may focus more on financial structuring, flexibility, credibility, relationship management, and risk assessment frameworks. Therefore, a comparative and

analytical approach to studying these perceptions provides valuable insights into how Shriram Finance can optimize its offerings across both segments.

In recent years, the Indian financial sector has undergone rapid transformation due to technological advancements, regulatory changes, and evolving customer expectations. Digitalization has redefined the way financial services are delivered, making convenience and efficiency central to customer experience. Customers today are more informed, empowered, and demanding, expecting seamless digital interfaces, quick loan approvals, and personalized solutions. In this context, customer perception becomes even more dynamic and critical, as it is influenced not only by traditional factors like interest rates and repayment terms but also by digital experience, brand trust, and service innovation.

Shriram Finance, with its extensive reach and customer centric approach, operates in a unique position within this evolving landscape. The company has historically focused on serving segments that are often overlooked by traditional banks, such as small transport operators, rural entrepreneurs, and informal sector participants. This focus has enabled it to build strong relationships with customers who may not have access to formal banking channels. However, as competition intensifies and customer expectations rise, maintaining positive customer perception becomes increasingly challenging and essential.

The concept of customer perception is inherently multidimensional. It encompasses various aspects such as perceived service quality, perceived value, trust, satisfaction, and loyalty. In the context of lending services, these dimensions are influenced by multiple factors, including interest rates, loan processing time, documentation requirements, staff behaviour, communication clarity, and grievance redressal mechanisms. Additionally, external factors such as economic conditions, regulatory policies, and market competition also play a role in shaping customer perceptions.

This study aims to delve deeply into these dimensions, examining how customers of Shriram Finance perceive its retail and institutional loan offerings. By analysing customer feedback, experiences, and expectations, the study seeks to identify key drivers of satisfaction and dissatisfaction. It also aims to explore the gaps between customer expectations and actual service delivery, which can provide valuable insights for improving service quality and enhancing customer experience.

One of the critical aspects of this study is the distinction between perception and reality. Customer perception is not always aligned with objective measures of service quality or financial performance. Instead, it is shaped by subjective experiences, personal biases, and individual expectations. For instance, two customers receiving the same loan product under similar conditions may perceive the service differently based on their prior experiences, level of financial literacy, and personal preferences. Therefore, understanding customer perception requires a nuanced and empathetic approach that goes beyond quantitative metrics.

In the case of retail loans, customer perception is often influenced by factors such as ease of application, speed of approval, transparency of terms, and post-loan support. Customers in this segment may have limited financial literacy and may rely heavily on the guidance and support provided by the lending institution. Therefore, clear communication, ethical practices, and responsive customer service are crucial in shaping positive perceptions.

Institutional customers, on the other hand, operate in a more structured and formal environment. Their perception of a lending institution is influenced by factors such as financial stability, credibility, flexibility in loan structuring, and the ability to provide customized solutions. Relationship management plays a critical role in this segment, as institutional clients often seek long-term partnerships rather than transactional interactions.

Another important dimension of customer perception is trust. In financial services, trust is a fundamental requirement, as customers are entrusting their financial well-being to the institution. Trust is built over time through consistent service quality, transparency, ethical practices, and effective communication. Any breach of trust, such as hidden charges, misleading information, or poor service, can significantly impact customer perception and lead to dissatisfaction or attrition.

The role of technology in shaping customer perception cannot be overlooked. With the increasing adoption of digital platforms, customers expect seamless online experiences, quick responses, and real-time updates. Digital lending platforms, mobile applications, and online customer support systems have become integral to the customer journey. Shriram Finance, like many other financial institutions, has been investing in digital transformation to enhance its service delivery and meet evolving customer expectations. The

effectiveness of these digital initiatives plays a significant role in influencing customer perception.

Furthermore, customer perception is also influenced by word-of-mouth communication and brand reputation. Positive experiences shared by existing customers can attract new customers, while negative experiences can deter potential clients. In the age of social media and online reviews, customer feedback has a far-reaching impact, making it essential for organizations to actively monitor and manage their reputation.

This study also recognizes the importance of demographic and socio-economic factors in shaping customer perception. Factors such as age, income level, education, occupation, and geographic location can influence how customers perceive and evaluate financial services. For instance, customers in rural areas may have different expectations and experiences compared to those in urban centers. Similarly, first-time borrowers may perceive loan services differently from experienced borrowers.

By analysing these diverse factors, the study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of customer perception towards retail and institutional loans at Shriram Finance. The insights derived from this analysis can help the organization identify strengths and areas for improvement, enabling it to enhance customer satisfaction, build stronger relationships, and maintain a competitive edge in the market.

In conclusion, customer perception is a critical determinant of success in the financial services industry. For a company like Shriram Finance, which operates in both retail and institutional lending segments, understanding and managing customer perception is essential for sustaining growth and achieving long-term success. This study serves as an important step in exploring the complex and dynamic nature of customer perception, providing valuable insights that can inform strategic decision-making and service enhancement initiatives.

1.2 Industry Profile

Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) and Lending Industry in India

I. The Indian financial services industry is one of the most dynamic and rapidly evolving sectors of the economy, playing a crucial role in mobilizing savings, facilitating investments, and supporting economic growth. Within this broad ecosystem, the NonBanking Financial Company (NBFC) sector has emerged as a vital component, complementing the traditional banking system by providing credit to segments that are often underserved or excluded by banks. The NBFC industry has witnessed significant expansion over the past few decades, driven by increasing demand for credit, regulatory support, technological advancements, and a growing emphasis on financial inclusion.

NBFCs are financial institutions that provide various banking services without holding a full banking license. They are regulated by the Reserve Bank of India and operate under a framework that ensures financial stability while allowing operational flexibility. Unlike banks, NBFCs cannot accept demand deposits, but they can offer a wide range of financial services, including loans and advances, asset financing, investment in securities, leasing, hire purchase, and insurance services. Their ability to cater to niche markets and provide customized financial solutions has made them an indispensable part of the Indian financial system.

The lending industry in India is broadly divided into retail lending and institutional (or corporate) lending. Retail lending refers to loans extended to individuals for personal consumption or small business purposes, such as vehicle loans, personal loans, home loans, gold loans, and consumer durable financing. Institutional lending, on the other hand, involves loans extended to corporations, financial institutions, and large enterprises for business expansion, working capital, infrastructure development, and other commercial purposes.

Over the years, the NBFC sector has played a pivotal role in bridging the credit gap in the Indian economy. Traditional banks often have stringent eligibility criteria, extensive documentation requirements, and a relatively conservative approach to risk,

which can limit access to credit for certain segments. NBFCs, with their flexible lending practices and customer-centric approach, have been able to reach these underserved segments, including small and medium enterprises (SMEs), self-employed individuals, rural households, and informal sector participants.

One of the defining characteristics of the NBFC industry is its focus on specialized lending. Many NBFCs concentrate on specific sectors such as vehicle finance, microfinance, housing finance, or gold loans. This specialization enables them to develop deep expertise in their chosen segments, understand customer needs more effectively, and design tailored products and services. For example, vehicle finance NBFCs play a critical role in supporting the transportation sector by providing loans to small fleet operators and individual drivers, thereby contributing to employment generation and economic activity.

The growth of the NBFC sector has been closely linked to the overall economic development of the country. As India has transitioned from a largely agrarian economy to a more diversified and industrialized one, the demand for credit has increased significantly. Rising incomes, urbanization, and changing consumption patterns have led to greater demand for retail loans, while industrial expansion and infrastructure development have driven the need for institutional financing.

In recent years, the Indian lending industry has undergone a transformation due to the rapid adoption of technology. Digitalization has revolutionized the way financial services are delivered, making them more accessible, efficient, and customer-friendly. Online loan applications, digital KYC (Know Your Customer) processes, automated credit assessments, and mobile banking platforms have significantly reduced the time and effort required to access credit. This has not only enhanced customer experience but also enabled NBFCs to expand their reach to remote and underserved areas.

Fintech companies have also emerged as key players in the lending ecosystem, leveraging technology to offer innovative financial solutions. These companies often collaborate with NBFCs to provide digital lending platforms, data analytics, and risk assessment tools. Such partnerships have created a more integrated and efficient financial ecosystem, enabling faster loan disbursements and improved credit decision-making.

The regulatory environment for NBFCs in India has evolved significantly over time, with the Reserve Bank of India playing a central role in ensuring the stability and integrity of the financial system. NBFCs are classified into different categories based on their activities

and systemic importance, such as asset finance companies, loan companies, investment companies, and infrastructure finance companies. Systemically important NBFCs are subject to stricter regulatory requirements, including higher capital adequacy norms, enhanced disclosure standards, and more rigorous supervision.

The introduction of regulatory reforms has strengthened the resilience of the NBFC sector and improved risk management practices. For instance, the implementation of stricter asset classification and provisioning norms has enhanced transparency and accountability. Similarly, guidelines on corporate governance, liquidity management, and risk assessment have contributed to the overall stability of the sector.

Despite its growth and importance, the NBFC industry faces several challenges. One of the key challenges is access to funding. Unlike banks, which can mobilize low-cost deposits, NBFCs rely heavily on borrowings from banks, financial institutions, and capital markets. This makes them more vulnerable to changes in market conditions and liquidity constraints. The sector has experienced periods of stress in the past, particularly during times of economic uncertainty, highlighting the need for robust risk management and prudent financial practices.

1. Banking Sector

The Indian banking sector consists of both public and private sector banks where State Bank of India (SBI) holds the position as the largest public sector bank. The market leadership in private banking belongs to HDFC Bank together with ICICI Bank and Axis Bank. The banking sector provides its customers with savings and current accounts alongside personal loans and mortgages and corporate loans.

2. Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)

NBFCs function as major financial institutions throughout the Indian market. These institutions deliver financial services through loans and asset management and leasing to both businesses and individuals. NBFCs serve as essential tools for financial inclusion of people who lack access to traditional banking services. Shriram Finance Limited stands as a leading NBFC in India which serves rural and semi-urban areas through its financial products including vehicle loans and business loans and insurance products.

3. Insurance Sector

The Indian insurance sector is divided into life and general (non-life) insurance segments. Major players in the life insurance market include LIC (Life Insurance Corporation of India),

HDFC Life, and ICICI Prudential. The general insurance market is dominated by companies like New India Assurance, Bajaj Allianz, and Reliance General. The sector is witnessing rapid growth due to increasing awareness and penetration of insurance products.

4. Asset and Wealth Management

The asset management industry in India has experienced significant growth, with mutual funds and wealth management services expanding rapidly. Companies like SBI Mutual Fund, HDFC Asset Management, and Reliance Nippon Life are prominent players. The increasing middleclass wealth and investment interest drive the demand for wealth management services, leading to the growth of asset management companies.

5. Stock Markets and Investment

India has two major stock exchanges: the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) and the National Stock Exchange (NSE). The investment market has become more accessible due to online trading platforms, and the rise of financial technologies (fintech) has enhanced investor participation.

Regulatory Environment

The Indian financial services industry is heavily regulated by key regulatory bodies:

- **Reserve Bank of India (RBI):** Responsible for regulating banking institutions, monetary policy, and overseeing the overall financial health of the banking system.

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI): Regulates securities markets and protects investor interests.

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI): Regulates and promotes the growth of the insurance sector.

National Housing Bank (NHB): Regulates housing finance companies

1.3 COMPANY PROFILE Shriram Finance Limited

Shriram Finance Limited is one of India's leading Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), recognized for its strong presence in retail lending, particularly in vehicle finance and small business lending. The company is part of the well-established Shriram Group, which has a long-standing reputation for serving underserved and underbanked segments of society. Over the years, Shriram Finance has built a robust business model centered on

customercentricity, operational efficiency, and deep market penetration, especially in semi-urban and rural areas.

1.3.1 Evolution and Formation

Shriram Finance Limited, in its current form, is the result of a strategic merger between Shriram Transport Finance Company Limited and Shriram City Union Finance Limited. This merger was aimed at creating a unified, stronger, and more diversified financial institution capable of offering a wide range of financial products under one umbrella. The consolidation enhanced operational synergies, expanded the customer base, and strengthened the company's position in the NBFC sector.

The origins of the Shriram Group date back to 1974, when it was founded with a vision to provide financial services to individuals and small businesses that were often overlooked by traditional banking institutions. The group initially focused on chit funds and later expanded into various financial services, including insurance, asset management, and lending. Over time, it developed a strong reputation for its customer-focused approach and its ability to understand and cater to the needs of the informal sector.

1.3.2 Vision, Mission, and Core Values

Shriram Finance operates with a clear vision of promoting financial inclusion and empowering individuals and businesses through accessible and affordable financial solutions. The company's mission revolves around delivering value to customers by offering innovative products, maintaining high standards of service, and fostering long-term relationships. The core values of the organization include integrity, transparency, customer focus, and social responsibility. These values are deeply embedded in the company's culture and guide its operations and decision-making processes. By adhering to these principles, Shriram Finance aims to build trust and credibility among its customers, stakeholders, and the broader community.

1.3.3 Business Model and Operations

Shriram Finance follows a diversified business model that encompasses both retail and institutional lending. The company primarily focuses on asset-backed financing, which helps mitigate credit risk and ensures better recovery rates. Its business operations are structured around various segments, including commercial vehicle finance, passenger vehicle finance, two-wheeler loans, gold loans, personal loans, and small business loans.

One of the key strengths of Shriram Finance lies in its extensive distribution network, which spans across urban, semi-urban, and rural areas. The company has a large number of branches and field officers who engage directly with customers, enabling it to build strong relationships and gain insights into local market dynamics. This grassroots-level presence is particularly important in reaching customers who may not have access to formal banking channels.

1.3.4 Product Portfolio

Shriram Finance offers a comprehensive range of financial products designed to meet the diverse needs of its customers. Its product portfolio can be broadly categorized into retail loans and institutional loans.

1.3.5 Retail Lending

Retail lending forms the core of Shriram Finance's business. The company is particularly known for its expertise in commercial vehicle financing, where it has established itself as a market leader. It provides loans for new and used commercial vehicles, catering to small fleet operators, individual truck owners, and transport businesses.

In addition to vehicle finance, the company offers passenger vehicle loans, two-wheeler loans, and personal loans. These products are designed to provide financial support for personal consumption, mobility, and lifestyle needs. Gold loans are another significant offering, allowing customers to leverage their gold assets to access quick and convenient credit. Small business loans are also a key component of the retail portfolio, supporting micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) in their growth and expansion. These loans are tailored to meet the specific requirements of entrepreneurs and small business owners, providing them with the necessary capital to manage operations, invest in assets, and scale their businesses.

1.3.6 Institutional Lending

Shriram Finance also engages in institutional lending, providing financial solutions to corporate clients, financial institutions, and other large entities. This segment involves structured financing, working capital loans, and other forms of credit tailored to the needs of institutional borrowers.

Institutional lending requires a different approach compared to retail lending, as it involves larger loan amounts, complex risk assessments, and detailed financial analysis. Shriram Finance leverages its expertise and experience to offer customized solutions that align with the financial goals and risk profiles of its institutional clients.

1.3.7 Customer-Centric Approach

A defining feature of Shriram Finance is its strong focus on customer relationships. The company has built its success on understanding the unique needs of its customers and providing personalized solutions. This is particularly evident in its approach to serving customers in the informal sector, who may lack formal documentation or credit history.

Shriram Finance adopts a flexible and empathetic approach to lending, taking into account the specific circumstances of each customer. Its field officers play a crucial role in this process, interacting directly with customers, assessing their needs, and guiding them through the loan application process. This personalized approach helps build trust and fosters long-term relationships.

Customer service is another area where the company places significant emphasis. It strives to provide timely and efficient service, addressing customer queries and concerns promptly. Feedback mechanisms are in place to gather customer insights and continuously improve service quality.

1.3.8 Risk Management and Governance

Risk management is a critical aspect of Shriram Finance's operations. The company has established robust systems and processes to identify, assess, and mitigate various types of risks, including credit risk, market risk, and operational risk. Its focus on asset-backed lending and diversified portfolio helps reduce exposure to potential defaults.

The company follows stringent credit appraisal procedures, ensuring that loans are extended based on thorough evaluation of the borrower's repayment capacity and risk profile. It also maintains adequate provisioning for non-performing assets (NPAs) to safeguard its financial stability.

Corporate governance is another key pillar of the organization. Shriram Finance adheres to regulatory guidelines and best practices in governance, ensuring transparency, accountability, and ethical conduct. Its board of directors comprises experienced professionals who provide strategic direction and oversight.

1.3.9 Financial Performance and Growth

Shriram Finance has demonstrated consistent growth over the years, driven by its strong business fundamentals and customer-centric approach. The merger of its predecessor entities

has further strengthened its financial position, enabling it to achieve economies of scale and operational efficiencies.

The company's revenue is primarily derived from interest income on loans, along with fees and charges associated with its financial services. Its diversified portfolio and extensive customer base contribute to stable and sustainable income streams.

In addition to organic growth, Shriram Finance has also focused on strategic initiatives such as expanding its product offerings, entering new markets, and leveraging technology to enhance efficiency.

1.3.10 Role in Financial Inclusion

One of the most significant contributions of Shriram Finance is its role in promoting financial inclusion. By providing access to credit for underserved segments, the company has empowered individuals and businesses to improve their livelihoods and contribute to economic development.

Its focus on rural and semi-urban areas has helped bridge the gap between formal financial institutions and unbanked populations. By offering tailored products and flexible lending solutions, Shriram Finance has enabled customers to meet their financial needs and achieve their goals.

1.3.11 Technological Advancements

In recent years, Shriram Finance has made significant investments in technology to enhance its operations and customer experience. Digital platforms have been introduced for loan origination, processing, and servicing, reducing turnaround times and improving efficiency.

The use of data analytics and artificial intelligence has enabled better credit assessment and risk management. Mobile applications and online portals provide customers with convenient access to their accounts, enabling them to track loan status, make payments, and access support services.

1.3.12 Competitive Positioning

Shriram Finance operates in a highly competitive environment, with banks, NBFCs, and fintech companies vying for market share. However, the company's strong brand reputation, extensive

distribution network, and deep understanding of its target segments give it a distinct competitive advantage.

Its specialization in vehicle finance and its focus on underserved segments have enabled it to carve out a niche in the market. The company's ability to provide customized solutions and maintain strong customer relationships further strengthens its position.

1.3.13 Corporate Social Responsibility

Shriram Finance is committed to social responsibility and actively engages in initiatives aimed at improving the well-being of communities. Its corporate social responsibility (CSR) activities focus on areas such as education, healthcare, skill development, and environmental sustainability.

Through these initiatives, the company seeks to create a positive impact on society and contribute to sustainable development. Its commitment to ethical practices and social responsibility reinforces its reputation as a responsible and trustworthy organization.

1.3.14 Future Outlook

The future of Shriram Finance appears promising, supported by strong economic growth, increasing demand for credit, and favourable regulatory policies. The company is wellpositioned to capitalize on emerging opportunities in the lending industry, particularly in the areas of digital lending and financial inclusion.

However, it also faces challenges such as regulatory changes, competition, and economic uncertainties. To navigate these challenges, the company must continue to innovate, enhance its risk management practices, and focus on customer satisfaction.

Review of Literature

- **Nit, S. R.** conducted a comparative study on the financial performance and growth of Bajaj Finserv and Shriram Finance Ltd. The study analyzed the financial strength, profitability, and growth trends of both companies. The findings revealed that Shriram Finance has maintained steady growth and a strong position in the non-banking

financial sector through effective financial management and customer-oriented services.

- **Dash (2022)** examined customer perception regarding endowment plans offered by private life insurance companies. The study found that customer awareness, trust, service quality, and financial benefits significantly influence customer preferences and satisfaction levels. The research emphasized the importance of customer-centric services in financial institutions.
- **Parida (2022)** studied consumer behaviour towards the digital sales channel of Shriram Life Insurance Company. The findings highlighted that digital platforms enhance customer convenience and accessibility. Customer satisfaction was found to depend on ease of use, information availability, and efficient service delivery.
- **Rana (2022)** analyzed consumer buying behaviour towards life insurance products offered by Shriram Life Insurance. The study concluded that product features, company reputation, and customer service are major factors influencing purchasing decisions.
- **Haralayya (2021)** conducted a financial statement analysis of Shriram City Union Finance. The study evaluated profitability, liquidity, and solvency positions of the company and found that the organization maintained a satisfactory financial performance during the study period.
- **Chethan and Panigrahi (2018)** carried out a study on credit appraisal practices in home loans at Sundaram BNP Paribas Home Finance Ltd. The research emphasized the importance of effective credit appraisal in minimizing loan defaults and ensuring sound lending decisions.
- **Sahoo (2022)** examined consumer buying behaviour towards life insurance products. The study identified customer awareness, service quality, and trust as key determinants of customer preferences and decision-making.
- **A.M. S., Kulandai Joel M. A., and Arul Dominic N. (2025)** analyzed the financial performance of selected Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) in India. The

study revealed that operational efficiency, profitability, and customer-focused services contribute significantly to organizational growth and sustainability.

- **Yoganandham (2023)** investigated customer satisfaction with housing loan services in Tamil Nadu. The study found that interest rates, loan processing speed, customer service quality, and repayment flexibility significantly affect customer satisfaction levels.
- **Singh, A.** conducted a financial statement analysis of Shriram City Union Finance Pvt. Ltd. The study highlighted the company's stable financial position and effective utilization of resources, contributing to long-term growth.
- **Nandish and Ayub Ahamed (2019)** studied credit appraisal of home loans and concluded that proper borrower assessment and documentation procedures are essential for reducing credit risk and improving loan performance.
- **Singh and Sinha (2025)** examined customer perception and satisfaction in digital loan processing with reference to Cholamandalam Finance. The study revealed that quick loan approval, transparency, and digital convenience positively influence customer satisfaction and loyalty.
- **Mohanty (2022)** analyzed investment perception towards Shriram Life Insurance Company's endowment plans. The findings showed that customers prefer investment products that offer security, returns, and reliable service quality.
- **Parida (2022)** studied consumer buying behaviour towards life insurance products of Shriram Life Insurance Company. The study concluded that customer trust, awareness, and service quality play a crucial role in influencing purchase decisions.
- **Nandurkar and Anute (2024)** evaluated customer perception towards savings instruments with special reference to fixed deposits. The study found that safety, returns, liquidity, and institutional reputation significantly influence investment decisions.

- **Jose (2011)** evaluated microfinance intervention programs in rural areas of Kerala and Tamil Nadu. The study concluded that access to financial services improves economic conditions and promotes financial inclusion among rural households.
- **Sriram (2010)** discussed the commercialization of microfinance in India and highlighted the challenges faced by financial institutions in balancing profitability and social objectives while serving customers effectively.
- **Sriram (2014)** reviewed the performance of Local Area Banks in India and emphasized the importance of customer-focused financial services, accessibility, and operational efficiency in achieving sustainable growth.

3. REASEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 NEED OF THE STUDY

The need for this study arises from the growing competition and transformation in the financial services sector, where customer perception has become a critical factor influencing the success of lending institutions. In the case of Shriram Finance Limited, which caters to both retail and institutional borrowers, understanding how customers perceive its loan products and services is essential for improving customer satisfaction, enhancing service quality, and retaining clients. As customer expectations evolve due to digitalization, transparency requirements, and increased awareness, it becomes necessary to analyse whether the company's offerings align

with these expectations. Additionally, differences in perception between retail and institutional customers require focused evaluation to identify gaps and areas of improvement. This study is therefore important for gaining insights into customer behaviour, identifying strengths and weaknesses in service delivery, and supporting strategic decision-making to enhance overall performance.

Another important aspect highlighting the need for this study is the role of NBFCs in promoting financial inclusion. Shriram Finance serves a large segment of underserved and unbanked populations. Understanding how these customers perceive loan services can help improve accessibility, trust, and service delivery, thereby enhancing financial inclusion efforts. Additionally, analysing customer perception helps in identifying strengths and weaknesses in existing products and services, enabling the organization to implement necessary improvements and strategic changes.

3.2 Scope of the Study

The scope of this study is limited to analysing customer perception towards retail and institutional loan services offered by Shriram Finance Limited. It focuses on evaluating various factors such as interest rates, loan processing time, documentation procedures, service quality, transparency, and customer satisfaction. The study includes both individual (retail) customers and organizational (institutional) clients, providing a comparative perspective on their perceptions. It is geographically confined to a specific area (you can mention your location if needed), and the findings are based on responses collected from a selected sample during a defined period. The study does not cover the entire customer base of the company or include detailed financial or operational analysis, but it provides meaningful insights into customer experiences and perceptions within the selected scope.

The study covers both categories of borrowers—retail customers and institutional clients. Retail customers include individuals who avail loans such as vehicle loans, personal loans, gold loans, and small business loans. Institutional customers include corporate entities, firms, and organizations that obtain loans for business and operational purposes. By including both segments, the study provides a comparative understanding of customer perception across different types of borrowers.

3.3 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

The primary objective of this study is to analyse customer perception towards retail and institutional loan services offered by Shriram Finance Limited.

The specific objectives of the study are as follows:

- To understand the level of awareness among customers regarding different loan products offered by Shriram Finance.
- To examine customer perception towards retail loan services such as personal loans, vehicle loans, and gold loans.
- To evaluate the level of customer satisfaction with respect to interest rates, loan processing time, and service quality.
- To identify the key factors influencing customer perception and decision-making while choosing loan services.
- To compare the perceptions of retail and institutional customers to identify similarities and differences.
- To identify the challenges and issues faced by customers while availing loan services.

3.4 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The research methodology adopted for this study is designed to systematically collect, analyse, and interpret data related to customer perception towards loan services offered by Shriram Finance Limited.

3.4.1 Research Design

The study is based on a **descriptive research design**, as it aims to describe and analyse customer perceptions, attitudes, and satisfaction levels. This design is suitable for

3.4.2 Data Collection

The study involves both **primary and secondary data** sources:

- **Primary Data:** Primary data is collected directly from customers through structured questionnaires or surveys. This includes information about customer experiences, satisfaction levels, preferences, and perceptions.
- **Secondary Data:** Secondary data is collected from company reports, official websites, research articles, journals, and other relevant publications to support the study.

3.4.3 Sampling Technique

A convenience sampling method is used to select respondents. Customers who are easily accessible and willing to participate are included in the study. This method is practical and cost-effective, especially when time and resources are limited.

3.4.4 Sample Size

The sample size consists of a specific number of respondents (you can mention, for example, 50, 100, or as per your project). The sample includes both retail and institutional customers to ensure a balanced analysis.

3.4.5 Data Collection Instrument

A structured questionnaire is used as the primary tool for data collection. The questionnaire includes both closed-ended and open-ended questions to capture quantitative and qualitative insights.

3.4.6 Data Analysis Tools

The collected data is analysed using statistical tools such as percentages, averages, and graphical representations (charts and tables). These tools help in interpreting the data and drawing meaningful conclusions.

3.4.7 Period of Study

The study is conducted over a specific period (e.g., 2020–2025 or a few months of fieldwork), during which data is collected and analysed.

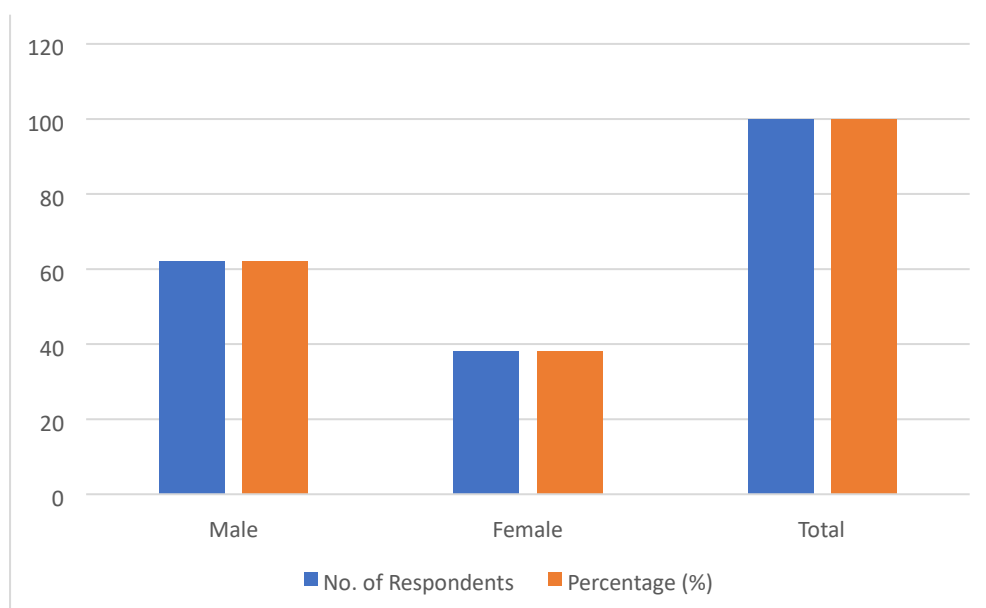
3.5 LIMITATION OF THE STUDY

- The study is based on a limited sample size, which may not accurately represent the entire customer base of Shriram Finance Limited.
- The use of convenience sampling may lead to selection bias, affecting the reliability of the results.
- The study is restricted to a specific geographical area, so the findings may not be applicable to other regions.

- The data collected is primarily based on respondents' opinions, which may be influenced by personal bias or inaccurate responses.
- Time constraints limited the depth of data collection and analysis.
- The study focuses only on customer perception and does not consider internal organizational factors such as policies, management decisions, or financial performance.
- Rapid changes in the financial services industry and customer expectations may make the findings less relevant over time.

Table 1: Gender of Respondents

Gender	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Male	62	62
Female	38	38
Total	100	100



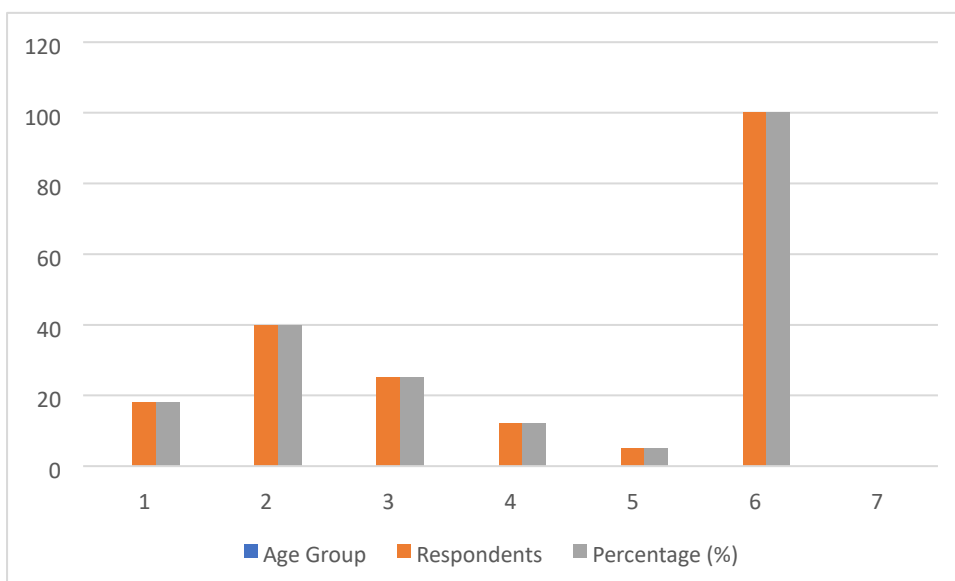
Interpretation:

As seen in the above table, the distribution of the respondents was based on gender. Total Number of Respondents: 100, 62% male and 38% female. This suggests that the sample of customers selected in the study includes a larger number of male customers. The higher participation of male respondents may be due to their greater involvement in financial and borrowing decisions. But the share of the female respondents is not to be ignored either, to enable a balanced view of a customer's attitude towards the loan service offered by Shriram Finance

Table 2: Age Wise Distribution

Age Group	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Below 25 Years	18	18
25–35 Years	40	40
36–45 Years	25	25
46–55 Years	12	12
Above 55 Years	5	5

Total	100	100
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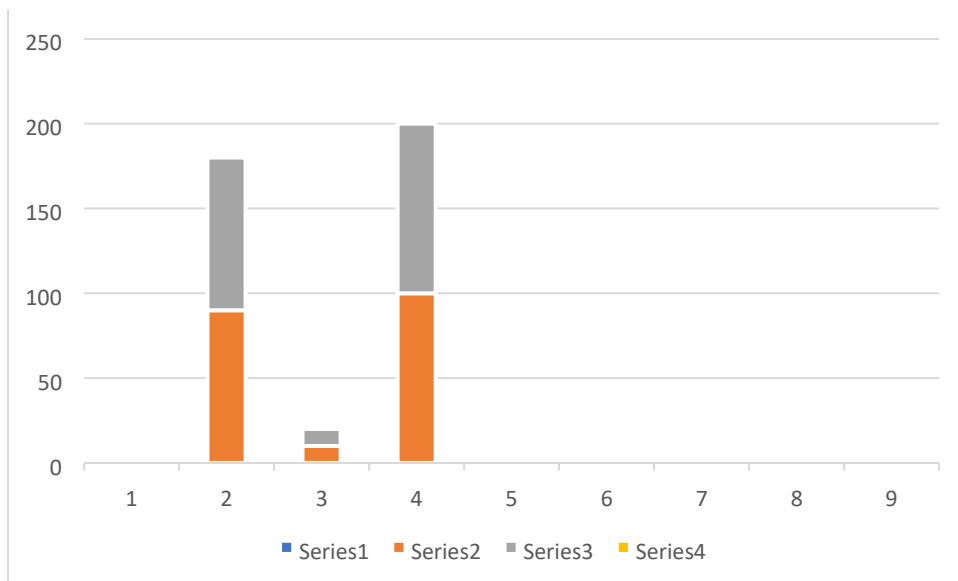


Interpretation:

The table shows that the largest age group among those that responded (40%) was 25–35-year-old. This is followed by the 36–45 years age group with 25% respondents. Mature people and young and middleaged people are more likely to secure loans for personal, business, car and family-related needs. The results revealed that the major age groups of customers preferred for Shriram Finance are economically active which includes people who need finance for different needs related to both personal and professional.

Table 3: Awareness of Loan Products

Response	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Aware	90	90
Not Aware	10	10
Total	100	100



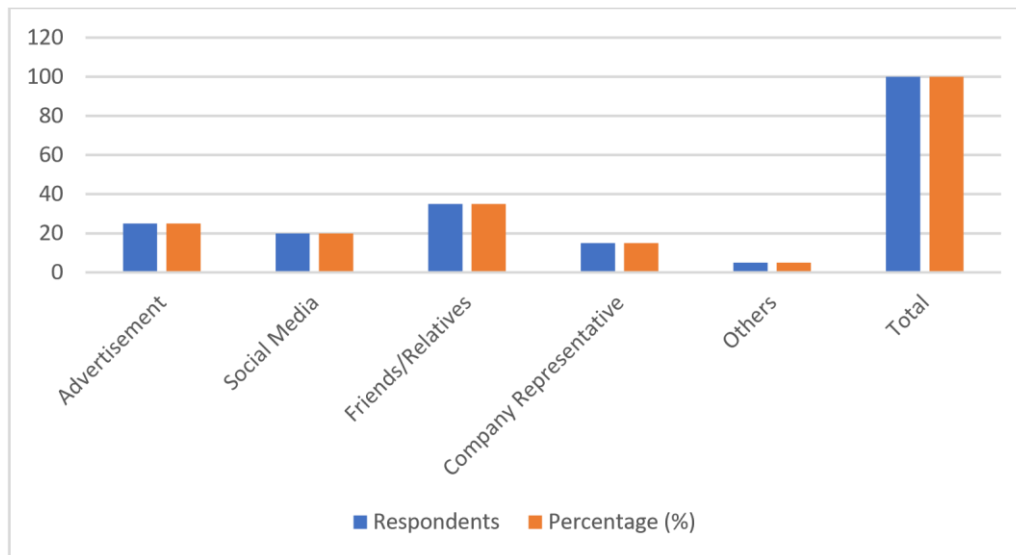
Interpretation:

The table shows that the largest age group among those that responded (40%) was 25–35-year-old. This is followed by the 36–45 years age group with 25% respondents. Mature people and young and middleaged people are more likely to secure loans for personal, business, car and family-related needs. The results revealed that the major age groups of customers preferred for Shriram Finance are economically active which includes people who need finance for different needs related to both personal and professional.

Table 4: Source of Awareness

Source	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Advertisement	25	25
Social media	20	20
Friends/Relatives	35	35

Company Representative	15	15
Others	5	5
Total	100	100



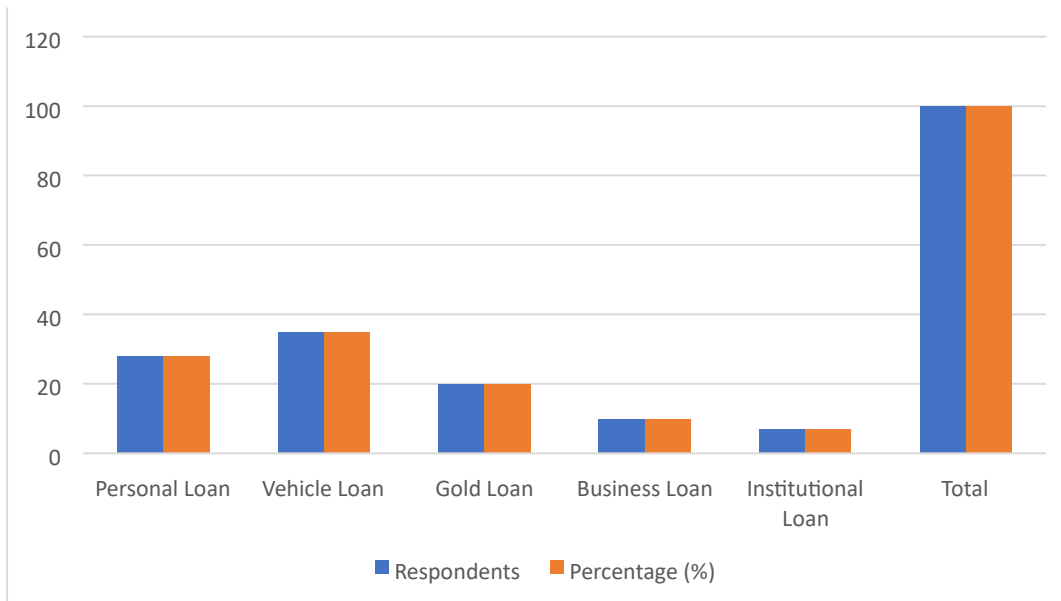
Interpretation:

Friends and relatives are the biggest source of awareness with 35% of the people who were asked about. 25% comes from advertisements and 20% comes from social media accounts. This means that "word of mouth" is a very important tool in persuading customers. Established clients' positive experiences in sharing trust can lead to the uptake of loan services among new customers. The results indicate that customer satisfaction could play a significant role on the company's reputation and its customer acquisition strategies.

Table 5: Loan Product Availed

Loan Type	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Personal Loan	28	28

Vehicle Loan	35	35
Gold Loan	20	20
Business Loan	10	10
Institutional Loan	7	7
Total	100	100



Interpretation:

From the table, it shows that the most common loan product availed by borrowers is vehicle loan, constituting 35% of the borrowers. Personal loans come in at second place with 28%, and gold loans come in with 20%. A smaller percentage of customers are using their business and institutional loans. This indicates that the car finance business is one of the best performing among Shriram Finance. This does not seem to suggest that the business may have created an impressive business footprint in vehicle lending, where there continues to be a big customer base.

Table 6: Overall Perception Towards Shriram Finance

Perception	Respondents	Percentage (%)

Excellent	22	22
Good	48	48
Average	20	20
Poor	10	10
Total	100	100



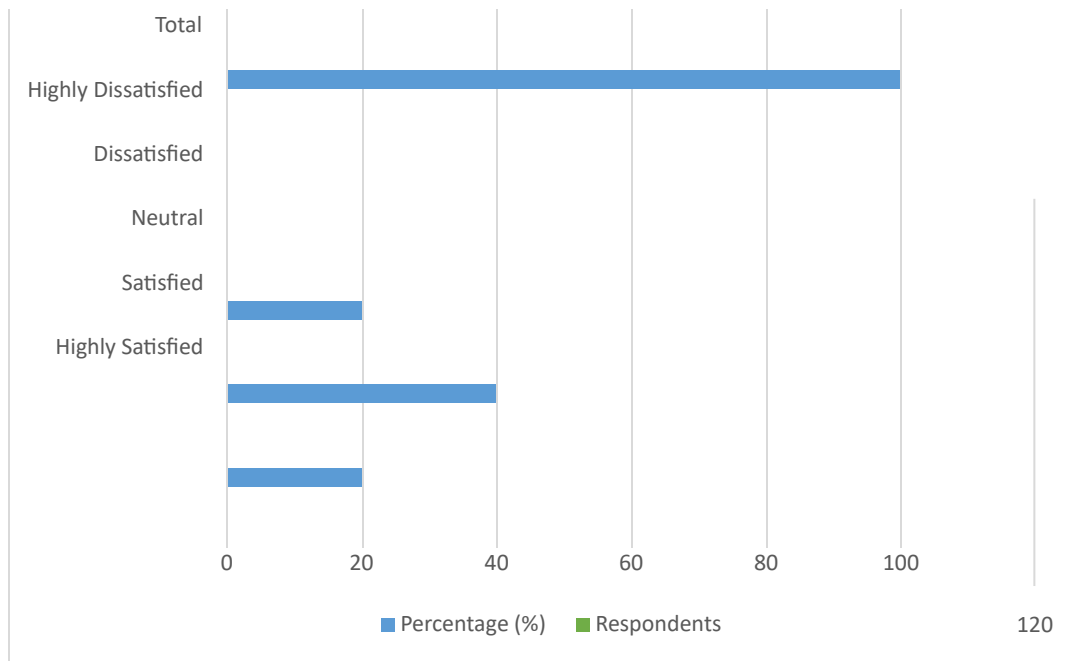
Interpretation:

Please see the above table and note that 22% rate Shriram Finance as EXCELLENT and 48% rate it as Good. Together, 70% of respondents have a positive perception of the company. 90% have a poor perception, 10% do not. This indicates that most of the customers have positive perceptions and are contented with the services provided by Shriram Finance. For a company to remain competitive in the financial services sector, attract and retain additional customers and retain the current customer base, the perception needs to be positive.

Table 7: Satisfaction with Interest Rates

Satisfaction Level	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Highly Satisfied	18	18
Satisfied	42	42
Neutral	25	25
Dissatisfied	10	10
Highly Dissatisfied	5	5

Total	100	100
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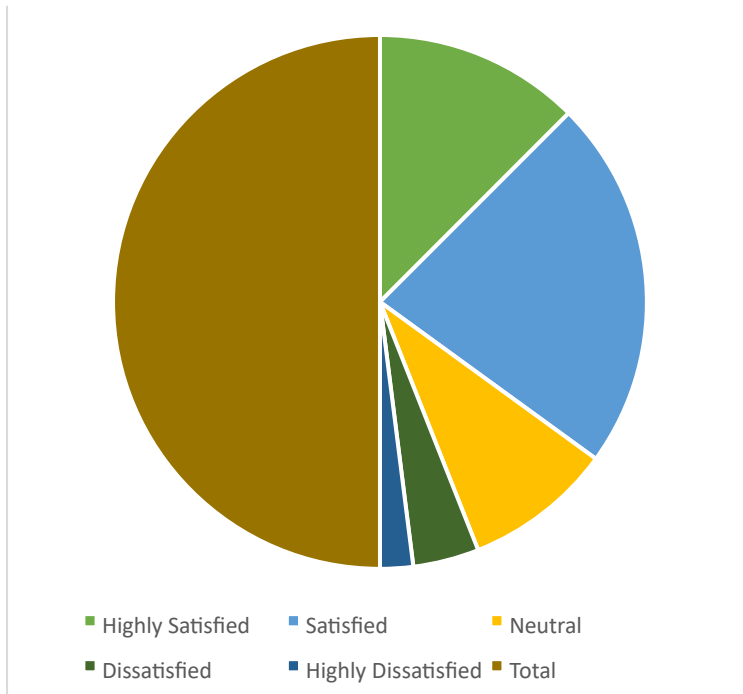
Interpretation:

The interest rates offered by Shriram Finance have indicated that 18% of the respondents are highly satisfied with the interest rates while 42% are satisfied. So, the total coming to 60% is satisfied. But, 15% are not satisfied or very not satisfied and the interest rates. This means that the interest rates are deemed reasonable by most of the customers, but not so fixed by few. The company can review pricing policies, and develop appropriate special policies for higher satisfaction of price sensitive customers.

8: Satisfaction with Loan Processing Time

Satisfaction Level	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Highly Satisfied	25	25
Satisfied	45	45
Neutral	18	18

Dissatisfied	8	8
Highly Dissatisfied	4	4
Total	100	100



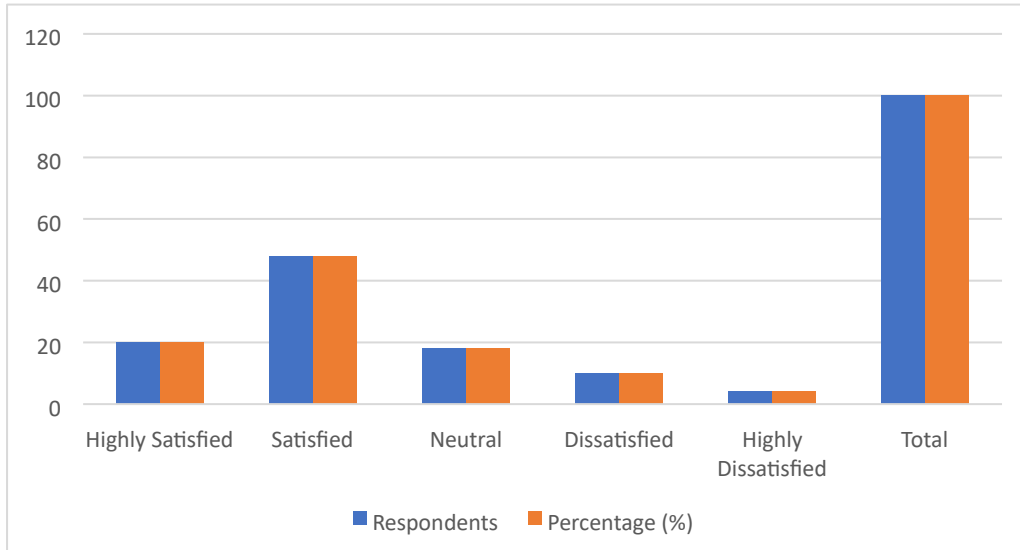
Interpretation:

The table shows that 45% of the respondents are satisfied with the loan processing time while 25% are very satisfied. A combined 70% of customers are satisfied with the loan application and disbursal process. Only 12% report dissatisfaction. This means that Shriram Finance has been effective in its loan processing services as well. The speed of processing is also a firm's area of strength as it helps to create customer satisfaction and makes customers easier to satisfy.

Table 9: Satisfaction with Customer Service

Satisfaction Level	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Highly Satisfied	20	20
Satisfied	48	48
Neutral	18	18
Dissatisfied	10	10

Highly Dissatisfied	4	4
Total	100	100



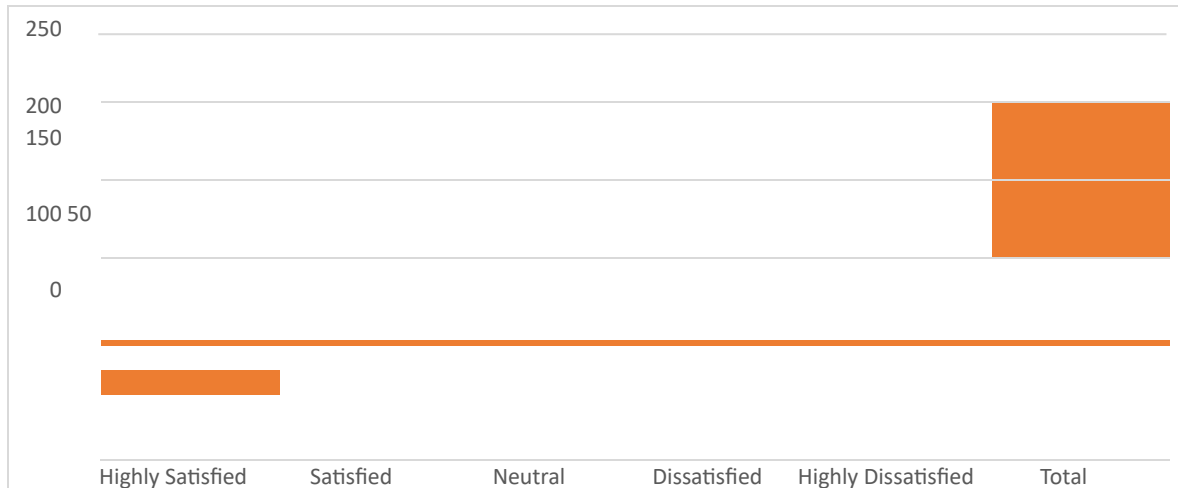
Interpretation:

As one can see from the table, 20% of the respondents are highly satisfied and 48 percent of them are satisfied with customer service. This is equivalent to 68% satisfaction with the support and help given by company's representatives. Customer service is crucial in improving customer trust, solving problems in a timely manner, and building a connection with customers. While the satisfaction level is good, there are areas on which the company can still work: to further strengthen customer experience and loyalty, it is important to improve the responsiveness and communication skills of employees to customers.

Table 10: Satisfaction with Repayment Options

Satisfaction Level	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Highly Satisfied	16	16
Satisfied	44	44
Neutral	24	24
Dissatisfied	12	12

Highly Dissatisfied	4	4
Total	100	100



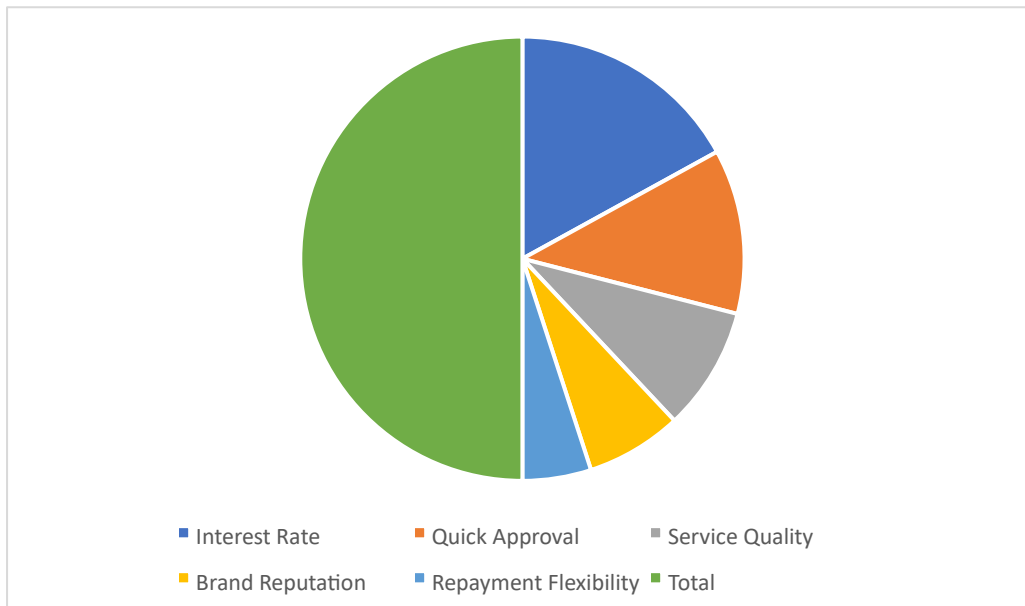
Interpretation:

As one can see from the table, 20% of the respondents are highly satisfied and 48 percent of them are satisfied with customer service. This is equivalent to 68% satisfaction with the support and help given by company's representatives. Customer service is crucial in improving customer trust, solving problems in a timely manner, and building a connection with customers. While the satisfaction level is good, there are areas on which the company can still work: to further strengthen customer experience and loyalty, it is important to improve the responsiveness and communication skills of employees to customers.

Table 11: Factors Influencing Loan Selection

Factor	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Interest Rate	34	34
Quick Approval	24	24
Service Quality	18	18
Brand Reputation	14	14

Repayment Flexibility	10	10
Total	100	100



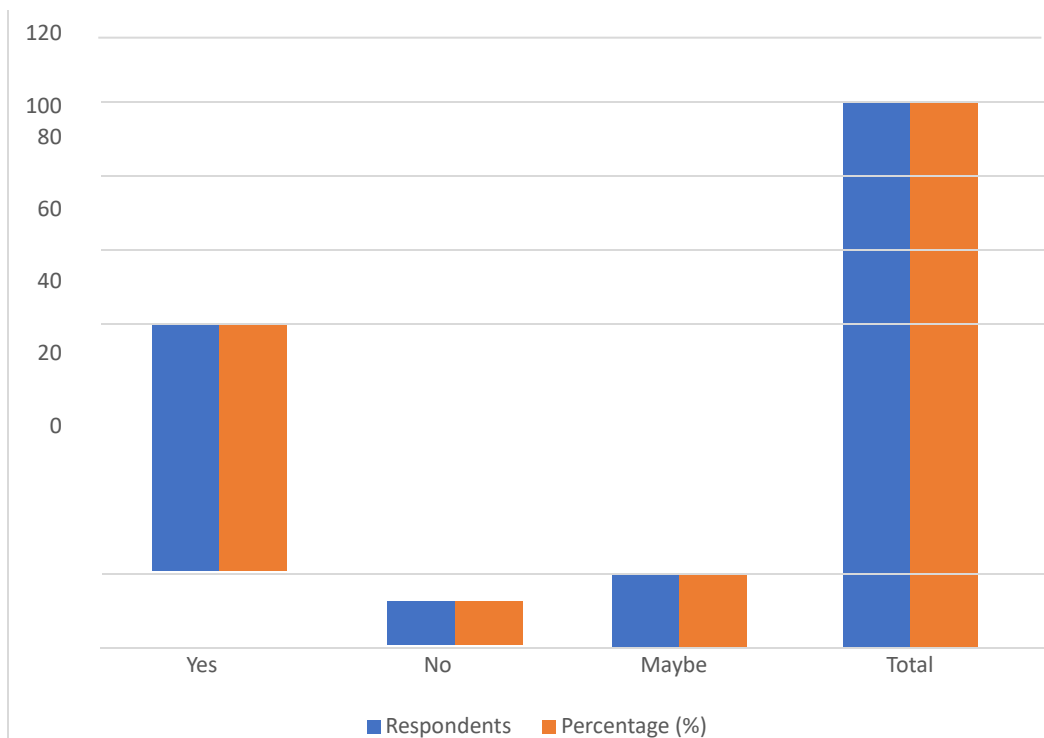
Interpretation:

The table shows that the most important or influencing factor affecting the loan services that customers choose is interest rate with 34% of the respondents marking it as their major factor or consideration. Quick approval is the second-most important, at 24%. This is followed by service quality, brand reputation and repayment flexibility. The number of customers that prefer low costs and quick processing to obtain a loan suggests that cost and timeliness are key factors in selecting a loan provider. Thus, Shriram Finance can attract and retain customers by keeping their rates competitive and having an efficient processing system.

Table 12: Recommendation of Shriram Finance

Response	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Yes	68	68
No	12	12

Maybe	20	20
Total	100	100



Interpretation:

From the aforementioned Table, it seems that out of the respondents, 68% would recommend Shriram Finance to others whereas 12% would not recommend it to others. The other 20% are not sure. A high recommendation rating means customers are satisfied with the company's services and trust their products, and that the company's services are satisfactory. You can benefit from existing customers' recommendations as this promotes positive word-of-mouth and brings new customers in. This is no surprise to the company since they are consistent with their reputation among the customers.

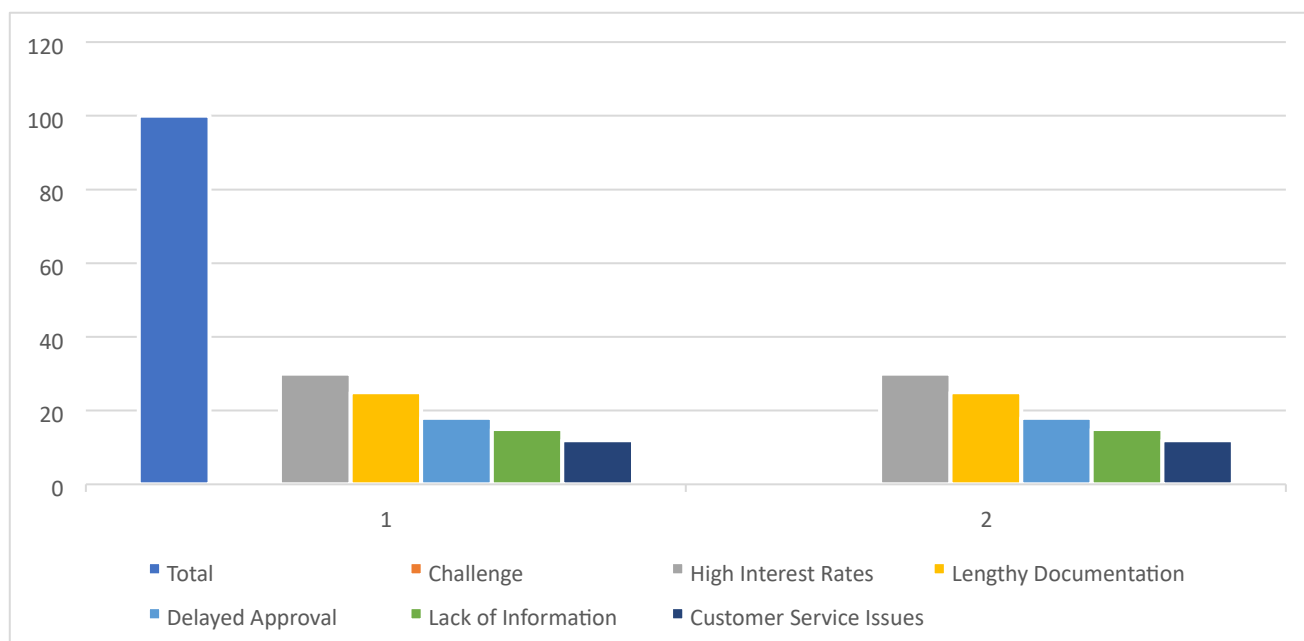
Table 13: Challenges Faced by Customers

Challenge	Respondents	Percentage (%)
High Interest Rates	30	30
Lengthy Documentation	25	25
Delayed Approval	18	18
Lack of Information	15	15
Customer Service Issues	12	12

Total

100

100



Interpretation:

From the aforementioned Table, it seems that out of the respondents, 68% would recommend Shriram Finance to others whereas 12% would not recommend it to others. The other 20% are not sure. A high recommendation rating means customers are satisfied with the company's services and trust their products, and that the company's services are satisfactory. You can benefit from existing customers' recommendations as this promotes positive word-of-mouth and brings new customers in. This is no surprise to the company since they are consistent with their reputation among the customers.

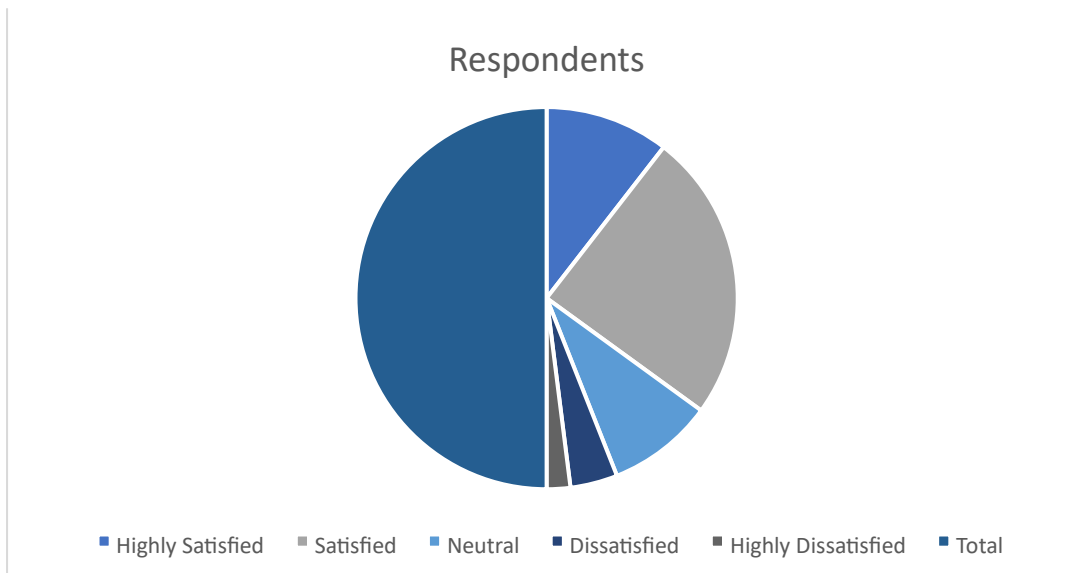
35

Table 14: Overall Customer Satisfaction

Satisfaction Level	Respondents	Percentage (%)
Highly Satisfied	21	21
Satisfied	49	49
Neutral	18	18

36

Dissatisfied	8	8
Highly Dissatisfied	4	4
Total	100	100



Interpretation:

The table shows that 21 % of the respondents are highly satisfied and 49 % respondent is satisfied about the overall service provided by Shriram Finance. Thus, a total of 70% of customers express satisfaction. 12% are not satisfied or very unsatisfied. This means the company has succeeded in achieving the required acceptance of the customers on the products of a loan processing, the quality of their service and the processing of the loan. Overall satisfaction is important for customer satisfaction, repeat sales and increased competition position.

5.1 FINDINGS

- Majority were male (62%), as male customers make up a larger proportion of the users of loans.
- The age group 25-35 is the most dominant age group with 40% customers who are people in their young age or middle age engaging Shriram Finance.
- 90% of the respondents were aware of the different loan products available at Shriram Finance.

- Friends and family members (35 percent) are the main source of awareness followed by advertisements (25 percent) and social media (20 percent).
- The most sought-after loan product is the vehicle loan which was obtained by 35% of respondents, followed by personal loans (28%).
- Majority (70%) of the customer having positive perception on the loan services of Shriram Finance.
- Approximately 60% of the respondents are happy with the rates of interest provided by the organisation.
- There's a positive response to the time to process the loans, with 70% rating it as satisfactory.
- Customer service quality is good, as 68% of people are satisfied with customer service provided by the company.
- About 60% of the respondents are content with the repayment features of loan products.
- Understanding of interest rate is the most crucial factor that a customer takes into consideration when choosing loan services from among the designed ones, and the interest rate in this instance comes in 34%.
- The second most important factor in the customer decision making process is quick loan approval (24%).
- More than half (68%) respondents are willing to recommend Shriram Finance to others.
- The interest rate is cited as the main challenge to the customers with 30% interest rate.
- One of the other issues that respondents encounter is lengthy documentation procedures (25%).
- 7/10 people are satisfied with the overall services provided by Shriram Finance after availed loan services, with satisfaction level being high.
- Its services are efficient, processing is fast and it offers a range of loan products, the study finds that Shriram Finance has a good reputation with customers. But more refinements in loan interest rates and loan documentation processes can further boost customer satisfaction.

5.2 SUGGESTIONS

- Lower Interest Rates: Shriram Finance might try providing competitive interest rates to encourage customers to choose the firm and develop customer satisfaction.
- Reduce paperwork: Company should minimise paperwork and streamline the application of a loan to make it easier.
- Build Customer Awareness: New promotions and financial education programmes can be staged and financially education message on the internet can be promoted.
- Enhance Employee Communication Skills, Customer Services: Conduct training to improve communication skills of employees and customer relationship management.

- **Technology and Digital Verification:** Technology can also be further improved to speed up the loan approval process and enhance customer satisfaction levels.
- **Implement Flexible Repayment Options:** Allow for customisable repayment plans for customers according to their income and financial situation for greater convenience.
- **Enhance Digital Services:** Improve customer access to loans and customer services by creating intuitive online platforms and mobile applications.
- **Promote Transparency:** Providing clear communication about interest rates, charges, and loan terms can enhance customer trust and prevent misunderstandings.
- **Maintain a Complaint Resolution process:** The complaints handling process should be fast, efficient and available to rectify customer concerns as soon as possible.
- **Perform Periodic Customer Feedback Forms:** Periodic customer feedback surveys may uncover areas for improvement and improve the quality of loan services.

5.3 CONCLUSION

The study on **Customer Perception Towards Retail and Institutional Loans at Shriram Finance** reveals that customers generally have a positive perception of the company's loan services. The findings indicate that a majority of respondents are aware of the various loan products offered by Shriram Finance, with vehicle loans being the most preferred loan product. Most customers came to know about the company's services through friends and relatives, highlighting the importance of word-of-mouth promotion.

The study also shows that customers are satisfied with the company's loan processing time, customer service, and repayment options. Interest rate and quick loan approval are identified

as the major factors influencing customers while selecting loan services. Although the overall satisfaction level is high, some customers have expressed concerns regarding high interest rates and lengthy documentation procedures.

Overall, Shriram Finance has been successful in building customer trust and maintaining a favourable reputation in the financial services market. The company enjoys a good level of customer satisfaction and loyalty. However, by reducing interest rates, simplifying documentation procedures, improving digital services, and enhancing customer support, Shriram Finance can further strengthen its customer relationships and improve its competitive position in the lending industry.

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5.4.2 Websites

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3. [India Brand Equity Foundation \(IBEF\) – Financial Services Industry](#) – Information related to financial services growth and lending practices in India

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6.QUESTIONNAIRE

Personal Information

1. Gender ☐ Male ☐
Female
2. Age ☐ Below 25 Years
☐ 25–35 Years ☐ 36–
45 Years ☐ Above 45
Years

3. Occupation ☐ Student
- ☐ Salaried Employee ☐
- ☐ Business ☐ Self-
- Employed ☐ Others

4. Monthly Income ☐ ☐
- Below ₹20,000 ☐
- ₹20,001–₹40,000 ☐
- ₹40,001–₹60,000 ☐
- Above ₹60,000

Loan Awareness and Usage

5. Are you aware of the loan products offered by Shriram Finance?
- ☐ Yes ☐ No
6. Which loan product have you availed?
- ☐ ☐ Personal Loan
- ☐ ☐ Vehicle Loan ☐
- ☐ Gold Loan ☐ ☐
- Business Loan
7. How did you come to know about Shriram Finance?
- ☐ ☐ Advertisement
- ☐ ☐ social media ☐
- ☐ Friends/Relatives
- ☐ ☐ Others

Customer Perception

8. How do you rate the overall services of Shriram Finance?

☐ ☐ Excellent ☐

☐ Good ☐ ☐

Average ☐ ☐

Poor

9. How satisfied are you with the interest rates?

☐ ☐ Highly

Satisfied ☐ ☐

Satisfied

☐ ☐ Neutral ☐

☐ Dissatisfied

10. How satisfied are you with loan processing time?

• ☐ Highly Satisfied

• ☐ Satisfied

• ☐ Neutral

• ☐ Dissatisfied

11. How satisfied are you with customer service?

• ☐ Highly Satisfied

• ☐ Satisfied

• ☐ Neutral

- ☐ Dissatisfied

12. How satisfied are you with repayment options?

- ☐ Highly Satisfied
- ☐ Satisfied
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Dissatisfied

Factors and Challenges

13. Which factor influenced you most while choosing a loan?

- ☐ Interest Rate
- ☐ Quick Approval
- ☐ Service Quality
- ☐ Reputation

14. What is the major challenge faced while availing a loan?

- ☐ High Interest Rate
- ☐ Documentation Process
- ☐ Delayed Approval
- ☐ Lack of Information

15. Would you recommend Shriram Finance to others?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe



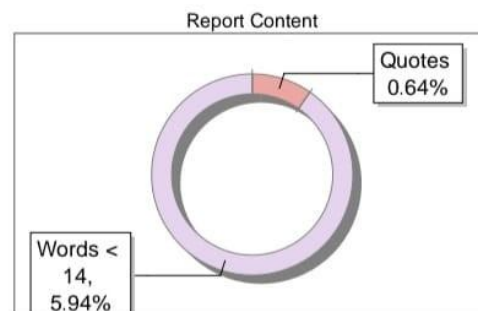
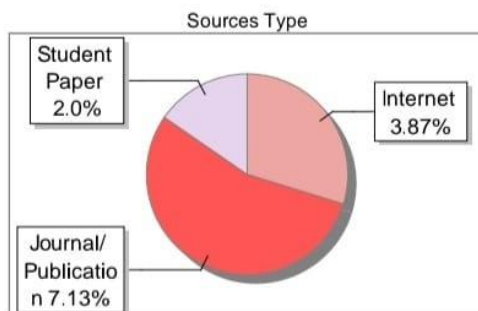
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D-Unacceptable (61-100%)

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3	www.fsb.org	<1	Publication
4	econeurasia.com	<1	Publication
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